

Music of the 55 Cancri Binary Star System

For Cello + Modular Synthesizer

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Pitches

Parts 1 and 3 use notes inspired by distances between planets so some notes are specified to be sharp or flat by a number of cents. The numbers are a guide and a target however absolute precision is not expected for non-synthesizer instruments and playing with a tuner is optional.

Players may explore timbre and dynamics at will. The synth-player should take care not to avoid excessive complex modulation that may obscure the pitches.

Structure

Timings are approximate. Players may wish to use a stopwatch as a guide.

Part 1 - 00:00 - 08:00

Pitches should be played in unison by players in ascending order 3-5 times (starting from the bottom-left of the image).

Following this, notes may be explored independently by players, in any order they choose and in any octave. Notes should be long and slow.

After ~7 minutes, players should resume playing the pitches in the original order in unison.

Part 2 - 08:00 - 17:00

Players should sonify the image working loosely from the top-left to the bottom-right.

The page opposite suggests some techniques to use to do this. Any pitched sounds should be muted and atonal.

Part 3 - 17:00 - 25:00

Pitches should be played in unison by players in ascending order 3-5 times (starting from the bottom-left of the image).

Following this, notes may be explored independently by players, in any order they choose and in any octave. Rhythms may be improvised and notes may be played faster than Part 1.

After ~7 minutes, players should resume playing the pitches in the original order in unison.

Following this players should create light sound effects that fade out over 20-30 seconds.

Sound Effects (Cello)

The player may use delay or other pedals to enhance effects.

Nebula/Dust

Circular bowing on bridge, white noise effect.
Bowing on side and tail piece.

Atmosphere

Very light pressure bowing, muted strings, air noise.

Particles

Atonal muted pizzicato, pitches unimportant, rubato.
Pizz behind bridge by tuning pegs.

Echoes

Col Legno, rubato, loose ghost jete/ricochet, muted with left hand

Sound Effects (Synthesizer)

Nebula/Dust

Noise shaped through a resonant band pass filter

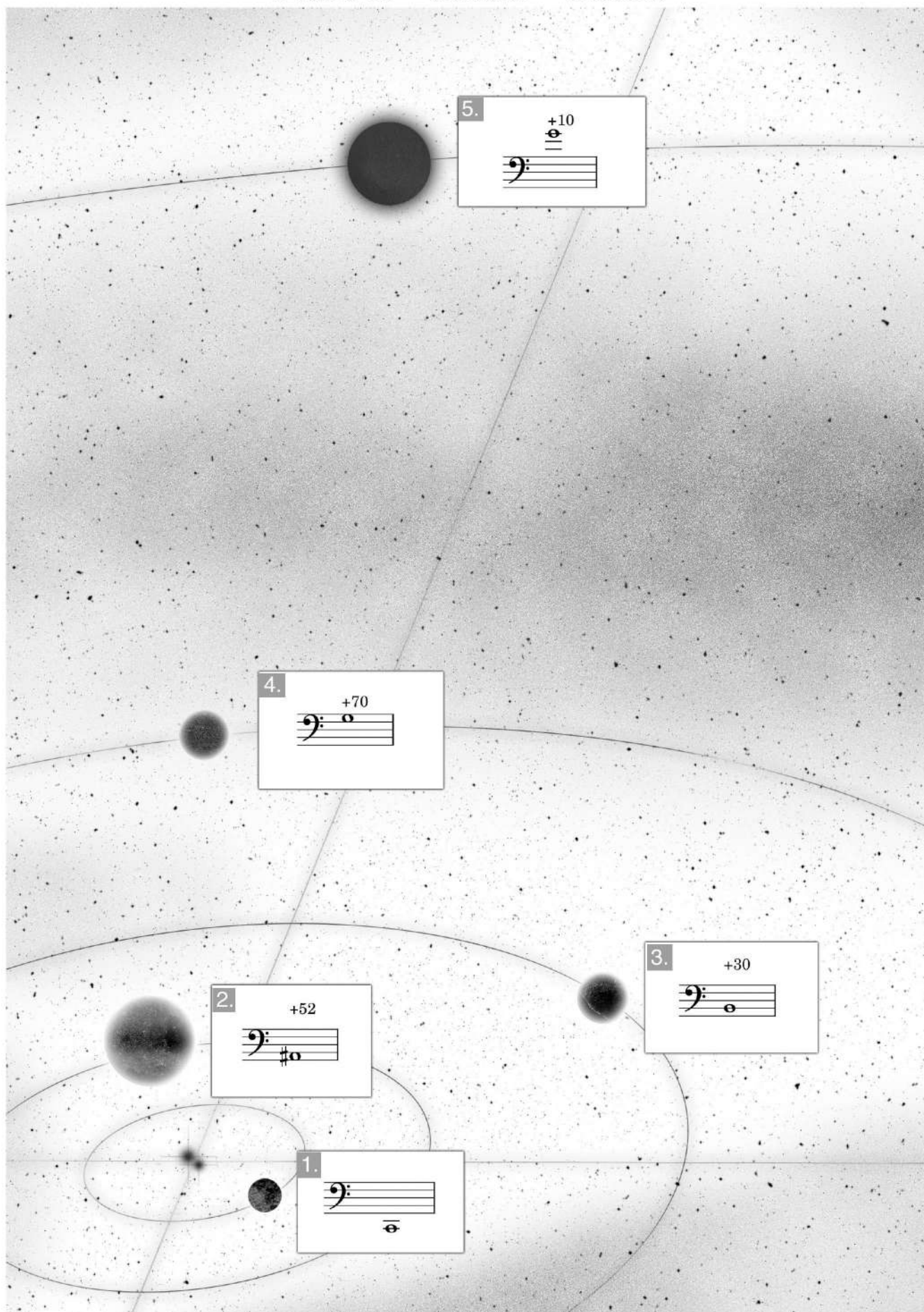
Atmosphere

Noise through a low pass filter

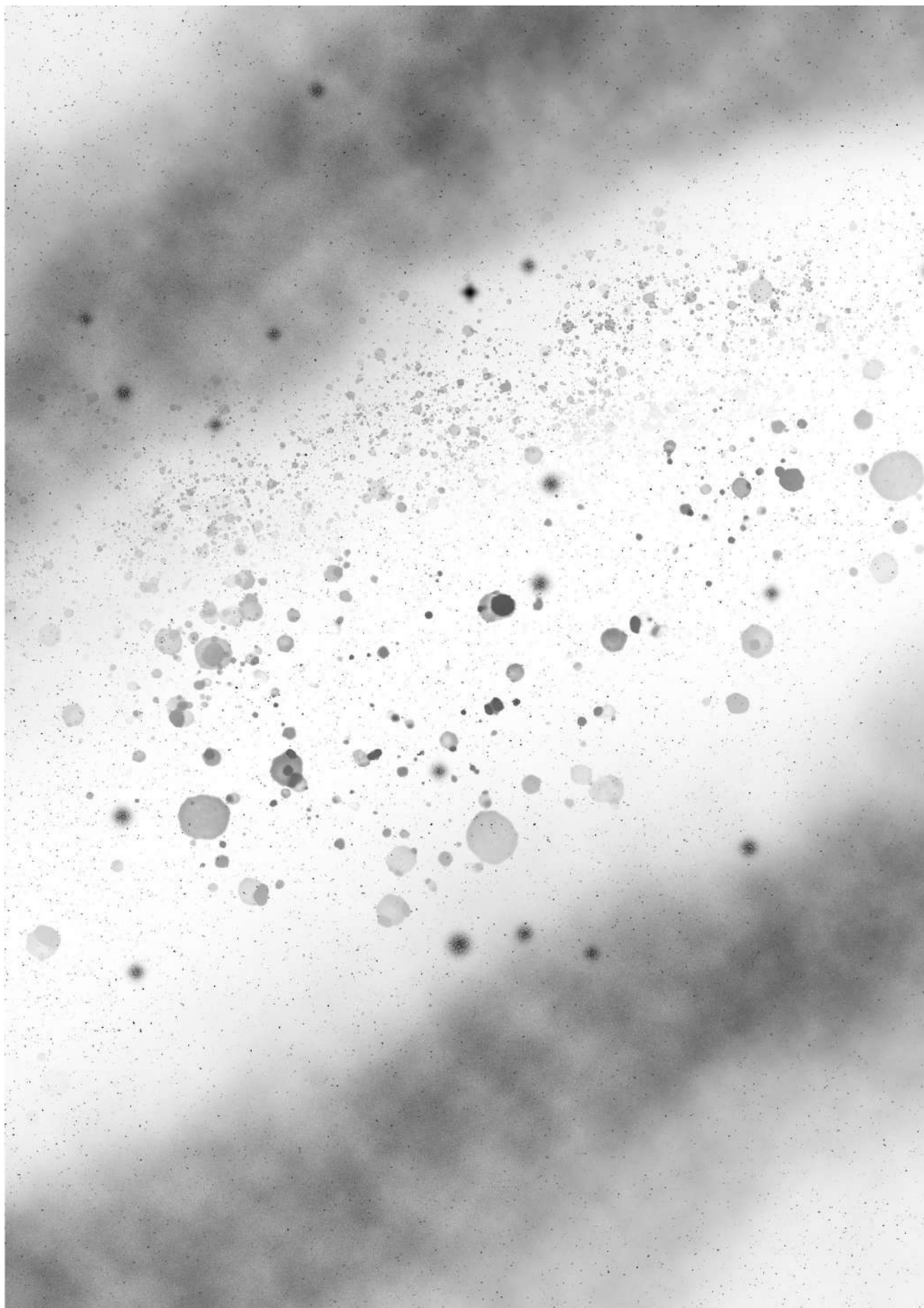
Particles/Effects

Filter pings with various modulation processed via time-based effects.

Part 1 - 00:00 - 08:00



Part 2 - 08:00 - 17:00



Part 3 - 17:00 - 25:00

